

AI Quote Generator

Professional Business Quotation Automation

Complete Workflow Documentation & Setup Blueprint

Generate Quote → PDF → Google Drive → Email → View Tracking → Accept / Reject → Status Updates →
Automated Follow-ups

1. Overview

The AI Quote Generator is an end-to-end quotation lifecycle automation built with n8n. It receives quotation data, generates a professional quotation and PDF, stores the PDF, sends it to the customer, tracks viewing activity, records Accept or Reject decisions, and sends automated follow-ups when no final decision is made.

2. Core Features

- Structured quotation generation.
- PDF generation and Google Drive storage.
- Professional Gmail delivery.
- View Quote and Download PDF actions.
- VIEWED status tracking.
- Accept and Reject actions from the customer email.
- Quote validation and expiry checks.
- Google Sheets lifecycle tracking.
- Customer action timestamps.
- Automated follow-up eligibility checks and reminders.
- Configurable maximum follow-up limit.

3. Technology Stack

n8n for workflow orchestration; **Google Sheets** for quotation records and lifecycle state; **Google Drive** for PDFs; **Gmail** for quotation and follow-up delivery; **Webhook nodes** for input and customer actions; and **Code nodes** for validation, calculations and data transformation.

4. Quotation Lifecycle

GENERATED → SENT → VIEWED → ACCEPTED / REJECTED, with EXPIRED as the expiry outcome. ACCEPTED, REJECTED and EXPIRED are terminal states and must not receive further follow-up emails.

5. Quote Generation & Delivery

Receive customer, business, pricing and validity data. Generate a unique quote ID. Create the professional quotation PDF. Upload it to Google Drive and store view and download URLs. Send the customer email containing the quotation summary and action buttons. Record the SENT status and sent_at timestamp in Google Sheets.

6. View Tracking

The View Quote link first calls an n8n webhook with the quote ID. The workflow retrieves the quotation record, updates status to VIEWED and records viewed_at, then redirects or responds so the customer can access the PDF.

7. Accept Workflow

Customer clicks Accept Quote → webhook receives quote_id and action → quotation is retrieved from Google Sheets → validation checks existence, terminal status and expiry → status becomes ACCEPTED → accepted_at, customer_action and customer_action_at are recorded → Google Sheets is updated → Respond to Webhook completes the request.

8. Reject Workflow

Customer clicks Reject Quote → webhook receives the request → quotation is retrieved → validation runs → status becomes REJECTED → rejected_at, customer_action and customer_action_at are recorded → Google Sheets is

updated → Respond to Webhook completes the request.

9. Recommended Google Sheets Fields

quote_id, status, customer_name, customer_email, total, currency, pdf_view_url, pdf_download_url, created_at, valid_until, generated_at, sent_at, viewed_at, accepted_at, rejected_at, expired_at, customer_action, customer_action_at, follow_up_count, last_follow_up_at, next_follow_up_at.

10. Follow-up Automation — Phase 4

A scheduled or manually triggered workflow retrieves quotation records and evaluates every quote. A quote is eligible only when its status is SENT or VIEWED, it is not terminal, it is not expired, follow-up attempts remain, and current time is greater than or equal to next_follow_up_at.

11. Follow-up Configuration

The workflow can use:

FOLLOW_UP_AFTER_DAYS = 3

MAX_FOLLOW_UPS = 5

After each successful follow-up, increment follow_up_count, set last_follow_up_at to the current timestamp, and calculate next_follow_up_at based on the configured interval.

12. Follow-up Processing Flow

Trigger → Get Google Sheets rows → Code node evaluates terminal status, expiry and eligibility → IF is_follow_up_due = true → prepare email data → Gmail sends follow-up → update follow_up_count → update last_follow_up_at → calculate next_follow_up_at → update Google Sheets → finish workflow.

13. Validation Rules

Before processing ACCEPTED or REJECTED, confirm that the quote exists, is not already ACCEPTED, REJECTED or EXPIRED, and has not passed valid_until. This prevents duplicate or invalid customer actions.

14. Testing Checklist

- Generate quotation.
- Generate and upload PDF.
- Verify view and download links.
- Verify quotation email.
- Verify SENT status.
- Test View Quote and VIEWED status.
- Test Accept and ACCEPTED status.
- Test Reject and REJECTED status.
- Test expiry validation.
- Verify terminal quotes do not follow up.
- Verify follow_up_count increments.
- Verify last_follow_up_at and next_follow_up_at.
- Verify the maximum follow-up limit.

15. Deployment Notes

Each active n8n webhook must use a unique method/path combination. If two active workflows use the same webhook URL path, n8n will report a conflict. When testing through ngrok, ensure links use the active public tunnel URL and publish/activate the workflow before production testing.

16. Future Improvements

Potential extensions: CRM integration, quote analytics dashboard, conversion tracking, sales-team notifications, rejection reason collection, automatic expiry processing, follow-up templates based on attempt number, Slack/Discord notifications, database storage for larger workloads, and signed or authenticated customer action links.

17. Final Architecture

Quote Generation & Delivery: Input → quotation creation → PDF → Google Drive → Gmail → Google Sheets.

Customer Interaction: View tracking → Accept/Reject webhook → validation → Google Sheets update.

Follow-up Automation: scheduled evaluation → eligibility check → follow-up email → follow-up tracking → Google Sheets update.

18. Conclusion

The completed AI Quote Generator is a full quotation lifecycle automation: generation, PDF delivery, customer interaction tracking, acceptance/rejection processing, state persistence and automated follow-ups. This document can be used as a setup blueprint for recreating or extending the workflow.